Max_imum

D E S I G N S

Brand Guidelines

Version 1.0 · October 2026

Prepared for Ryan Otieno, Founder & Graphic Designer

otienoryan786-lab.github.io/Max_imum-Designs

Design to the max_

Who we are

Behind every small business is an idea that deserves to look as good as it is. Max_imum Designs is a graphic design studio that gives Kenyan founders clear, confident branding without agency prices or freelancer guesswork.

MISSION

Give every Kenyan small business a brand it is proud of, at a fair and clear price.

VISION

A Kenya where good ideas are never held back by bad design.

OUR VALUES

Max effort

Every job gets our best.

Clear first

Plain words, clear prices.

Rooted in Kenya

Designed for local life.

Craft

Details matter.

Respect

Your idea is the hero.

02 LOGO

Our logo

A tile, an M, and an underscore. Three simple shapes that say: this is design, this is Max, and there is always more to type.



The tile

A rounded square, like an app icon or a canvas. It holds everything we make.

The M

Poppins Bold. Strong, open and easy to read at any size.

The underscore

A designer's cursor, waiting for the next idea. Lime inside the tile, violet or lime in the wordmark. It is our signature.

The wordmark

Max_imum in Poppins Bold with the underscore replacing a space. DESIGNS sits underneath in spaced mono.

Logo versions

Pick the version with the best contrast and the right shape. Always use the supplied files and never redraw the logo.



Primary · horizontal



Reversed · on Ink



Stacked · square spaces



Icon · app, avatar, favicon



Black · one-colour print



White · on Violet



Violet · one colour



Wordmark only

Clear space, size and misuse

Keep a margin of x on every side, where x is the height of the M. Protect the logo's shape, colour and spacing.



MINIMUM SIZES Horizontal 120 px · 32 mm Stacked 80 px · 22 mm Icon 16 px · 6 mm



Don't stretch or squash



Don't change the colours



Don't add shadows



Don't rotate or tilt



Don't use low contrast



Don't swap the underscore

Colour palette

Ink carries confidence, violet carries energy, lime carries the spark. Lime is a highlight, never a background for small text.

Midnight Ink

#0E0B24 **RGB 14·11·36**

CMYK ~ 61 · 69 · 0 · 86

Primary · backgrounds, headlines

Max Violet

#5B2EFF **RGB 91·46·255**

CMYK ~ 64 · 82 · 0 · 0

Secondary · buttons, links, accents

Volt Lime

#C6F432 **RGB 198·244·50**

CMYK ~ 19 · 0 · 80 · 4

Accent · one highlight per layout

Cloud

#F3F1FF **RGB 243·241·255**

CMYK ~ 5 · 5 · 0 · 0

Surface · cards, page backgrounds

Lilac

#D8CFFF **RGB 216·207·255**

CMYK ~ 15 · 19 · 0 · 0

Support · borders, dividers

Hot Coral

#FF5C4D **RGB 255·92·77**

CMYK ~ 0 · 64 · 70 · 0

Alert · warnings, errors

Graphite

#2A2745 **RGB 42·39·69**

CMYK ~ 39 · 43 · 0 · 73

Support · patterns on Ink

Slate

#6B6785 **RGB 107·103·133**

CMYK ~ 20 · 23 · 0 · 48

Text · captions, secondary text

CMYK values are indicative conversions. Always request a printed proof and match to Pantone only if the printer requires it.

Using colour, accessibly

Aim for roughly 45% Ink, 25% white and Cloud, 15% Violet, 10% Lime and 5% support colours.

Aa White on Ink 19.2 : 1 AAA	**Aa** Lime on Ink 15.0 : 1 AAA	**Aa** Ink on Lime 15.0 : 1 AAA
Aa White on Violet 6.4 : 1 AA	**Aa** Violet on white 6.4 : 1 AA	**Aa** Ink on Cloud 17.2 : 1 AAA
Aa Slate on white 5.4 : 1 AA	**Aa** Lime on white 1.3 : 1 Decorative only	**Aa** White on Coral 3.0 : 1 AA large

WCAG: 4.5:1 for body text, 3:1 for large text (18 pt+) and key icons. Never rely on colour alone.

Typography

One friendly, highly legible family does nearly everything. A spaced mono voice adds the designer's touch.

Aa

Poppins

Headlines, UI, wordmark, body copy

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789 KES 12,000 % +254

Mono accent

DejaVu Sans Mono · labels, tags, DESIGNS

H1 · POPPINS BOLD 40/48

Design to the max.

H2 · POPPINS BOLD 28/36

Brand kits for small businesses

H3 · POPPINS MEDIUM 18/26

Logos, social media and print

BODY · POPPINS REGULAR 16/26

Tell us your idea. We will shape it into a brand your customers remember.

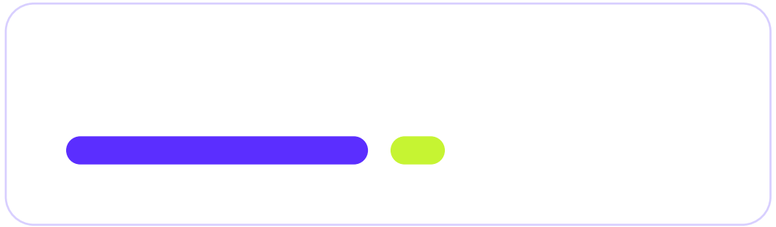
LABEL · MONO BOLD 10, SPACED

QUOTATION · INVOICE · BRIEF

Fallbacks: Arial / Courier New in Office files and email.

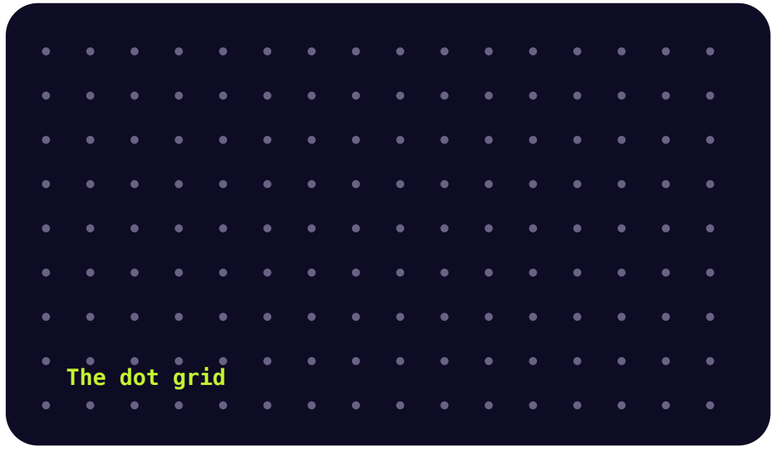
The underscore and friends

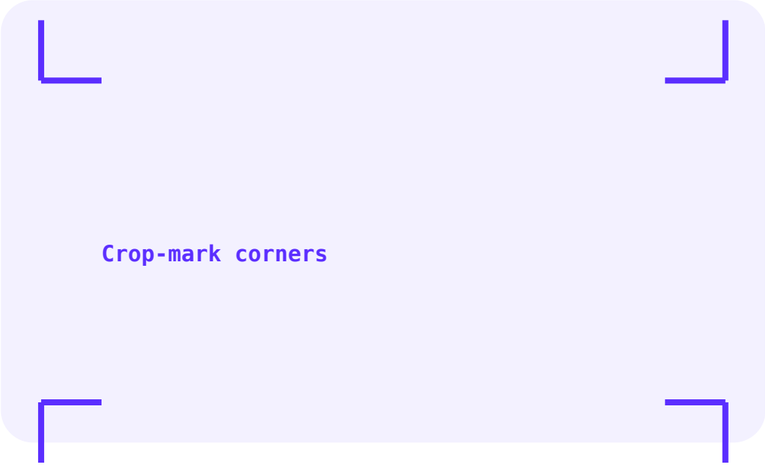
Our signature device is the underscore: a rounded bar anchored low and to the left, with a short accent beside it. Use it once per layout.













Corner radius: tiles 24% of size, cards 16 px, buttons fully round.

Voice and tone

We talk like a sharp, friendly designer: plain words, short sentences, confident but never loud. We always say the price.

SAY THIS	NOT THAT
Your logo is ready. Want to see it on a shirt, a card and a sign?	Deliverables have been finalised for review.
Quote: KES 12,000. Includes 2 rounds of revisions.	Pricing is subject to scope variation.
Not sure what you like? Send 3 brands you love. We will take it from t here.	Please provide your design references.
Asante sana! Your files are in the folder.	Transaction complete. Assets uploaded.

WRITE IT RIGHT

Max_imum Designs: capital M, underscore, one word.

Never "Maximum Designs", "MaxImum" or "Max-imum".

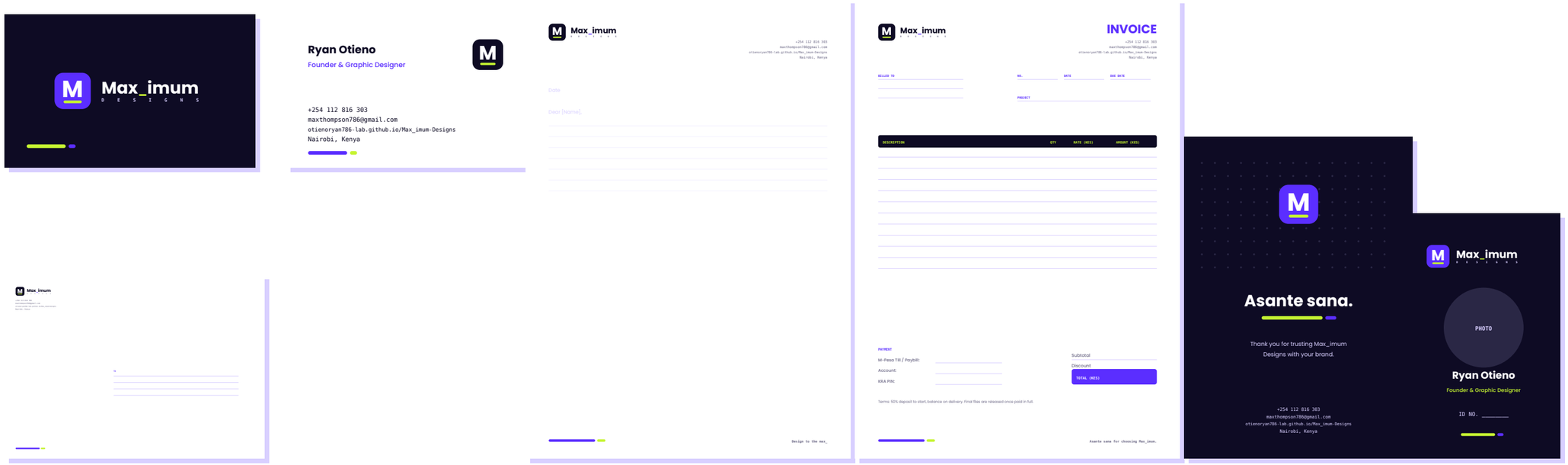
Money: KES 12,000.

Dates: 14 Nov 2026.

English first; Swahili for greetings (Karibu, Asante).

Stationery

A white page, one underscore, and Ink where it counts. Every item is its own print-ready PDF, with and without 3 mm bleed.

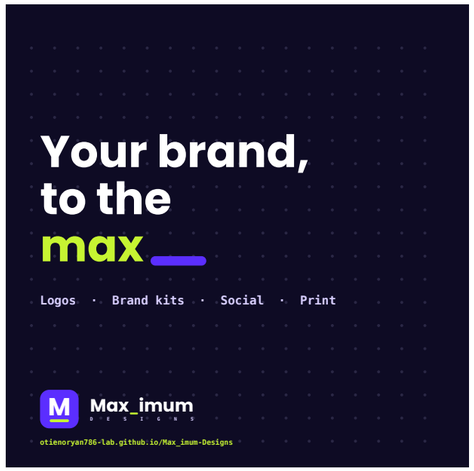


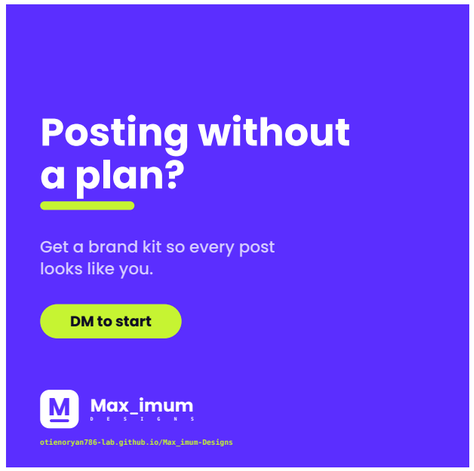
Business card · letterhead · invoice · thank-you card · ID badge

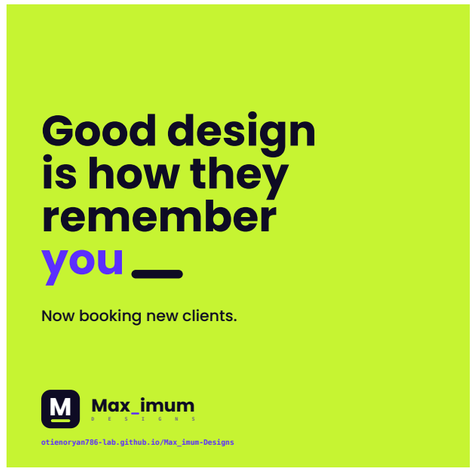
Also: envelopes C4, C3 and DL, compliments slip, quotation, creative brief, receipt, notepad, sticker, poster.

Social media and signage

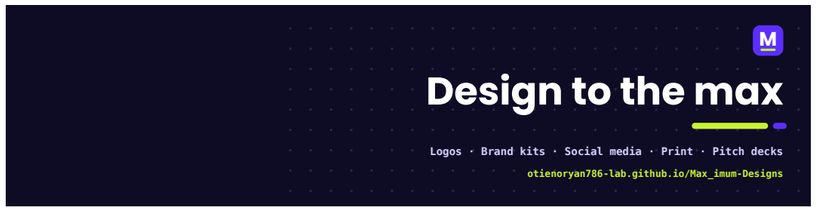
Same structure everywhere: a bold headline, the logo at the foot, one underscore. Same system on a phone and on a wall.















Instagram 1080 × 1080 · LinkedIn 1584 × 396 · Facebook 1640 × 624 · profile 1080 · sticker 100 mm

Quick checklist and next steps

- Use the supplied logo files. Never redraw or recolour.
- Keep clear space: x on every side.
- Ink leads; Lime appears once per layout.
- Poppins for everything; mono only for labels.
- One underscore per layout, low and to the left.
- Plain words, short sentences, KES 12,000.
- Always state the price and what is included.
- Check contrast: 4.5:1 for body text.

YOUR FILES

01_Logo
SVG, PNG, PDF · 4 families × 5 colourways

02_App_Icon_and_Favicon
App icon, favicons, Android foreground

03_Social_Media
Profile, banners, 3 post templates

04_Stationery
16 print-ready items, with and without bleed

05_Digital
Email signature

BEFORE LAUNCH

- Search the name with KIPI and register the trademark.
- Website is live: otienoryan786-lab.github.io/Max_imum-Designs. Consider a short .co.ke domain
- Ask a native Swahili speaker to review all copy.
- Add your KRA PIN and M-Pesa details before printing.